

4.1

Giving and asking for opinions

Worksheet

A You don't need any special phrases to give an opinion. However, using a few opening words will:

- show other people that you want to start speaking (useful in a formal meeting)
- give you a few seconds 'thinking time' to decide what you are going to say
- show how strongly you feel

May I come in here? Basically, ... I reckon ... I wonder if I could say something?
Actually, ... Well, from my point of view ... Wait a minute, ... Don't you think that ...?

Write the phrases in the box in the appropriate column below.

**Informal, direct language – for example
in a discussion between two people**

The point is ...
Frankly, ...

**Formal, careful language – for example
in a meeting with several people**

I tend to feel that ...
It seems to me that ...

B After giving your own opinion you need to ask other people for their opinions and keep the discussion moving. Write the phrases in the box in the appropriate column below.

What about you, Li? What's your reaction to that, Luca?
Walter? Would you like to add anything, Ginta?

An informal discussion

What do you think, Harumi?

A formal meeting

How do you feel about that, Pedro?

C Do the following:

- 1 Work in pairs. Choose a topic from the 'General' list, and have an informal, direct discussion.
- 2 Then form a larger group, choose a topic from the 'Business' list, and have a more formal, careful meeting to discuss the topic.

General

Violence on television
The future of China (or Russia)
Cars in cities
Traveling abroad
A current general news item

Business

Doing business on the Internet
Recruitment and selection techniques
The impact of globalization
Management: the latest ideas
A current business news item

D Discuss:

- Did you notice any language differences between the discussion and the meeting?
- What language did you need?

